



Journey to Education vs Journey to Work

New insights into education travel and how it differs from work travel

INSIGHTS & ANALYTICS

Tanveer Singh

Internship: Insights & Analytics Team, NZTA

Supervisor: **Chris Vallyon**

Principal Performance Measurement Analyst, NZTA

Why look at Journey to Education separately?



Traditionally Work-Focused

NZTA has historically focused on Work data;
Education data has only recently become available.



Peak Hour Impact

Student travel is a major contributor to peak-hour
congestion, often overlapping with work commutes.



Unique Dynamics

Students have different constraints, schedules, and
flexibility compared to commuters.



No Direct Comparison

Prior to this, there was no comprehensive direct
comparison between these two journey types.

What I'll Cover Today

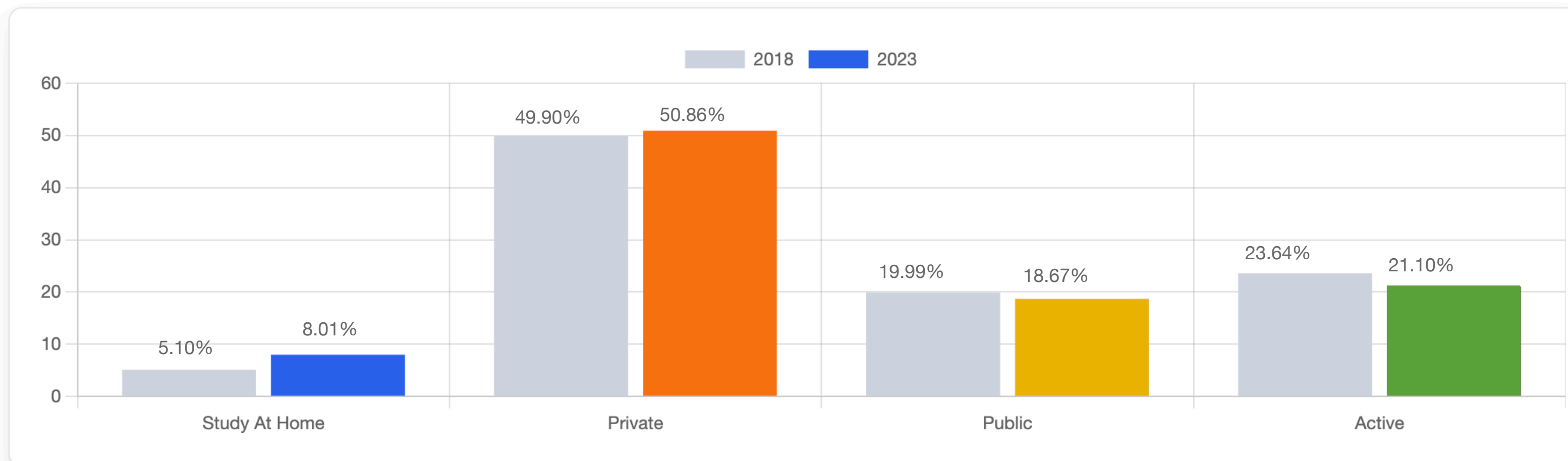
- 1 Journey to Education - Key patterns
- 2 Journey to Work - Brief context
- 3 Education vs Work - Where they differ
- 4 What this means for NZTA
- 5 Live Power BI Demo

How do students travel overall?

National Mode Share: 2018 vs 2023

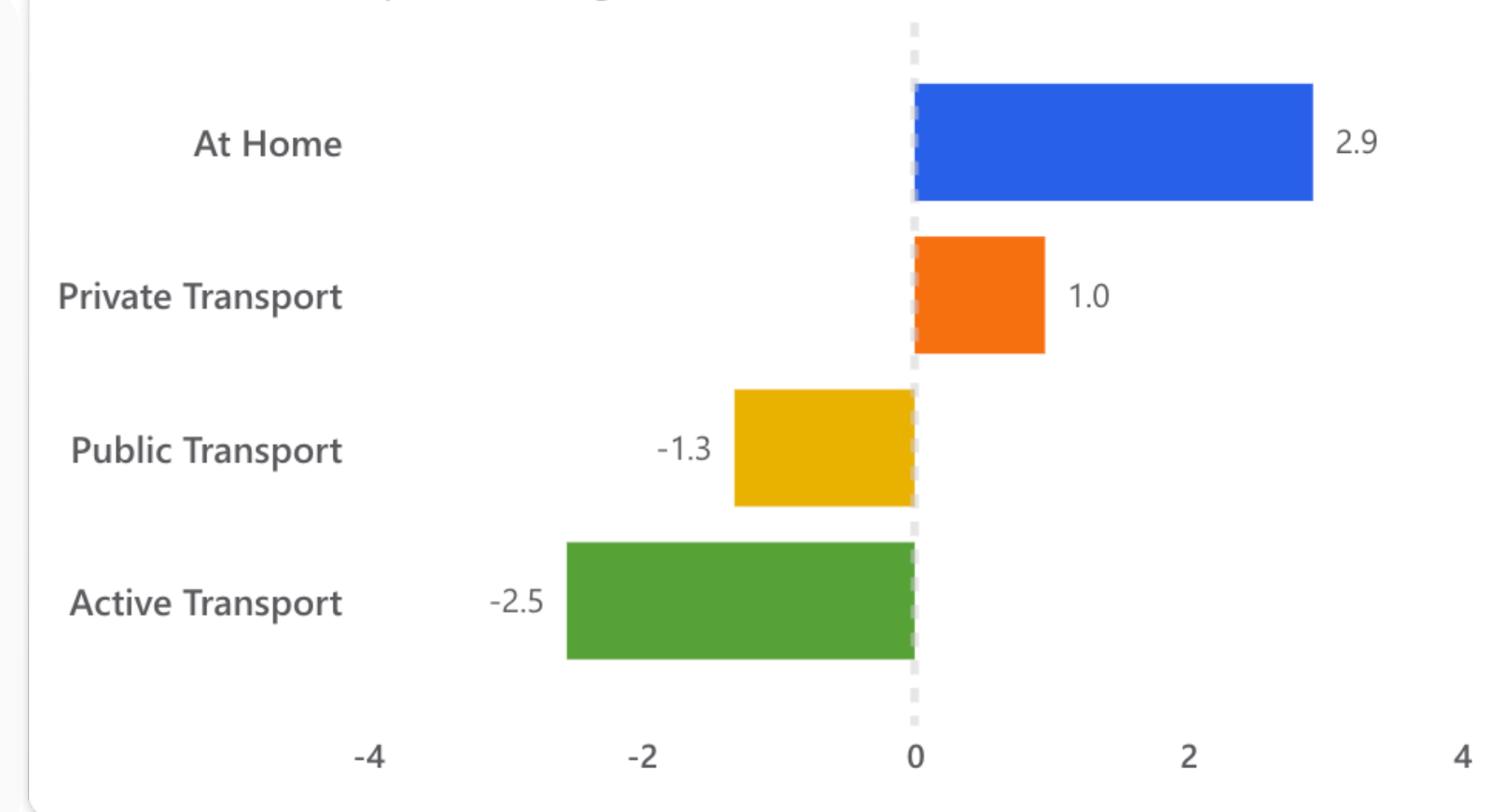


Mode Share % by Census Year and Travel Category



Net Change In Mode Share by Travel Category

National-level % point change





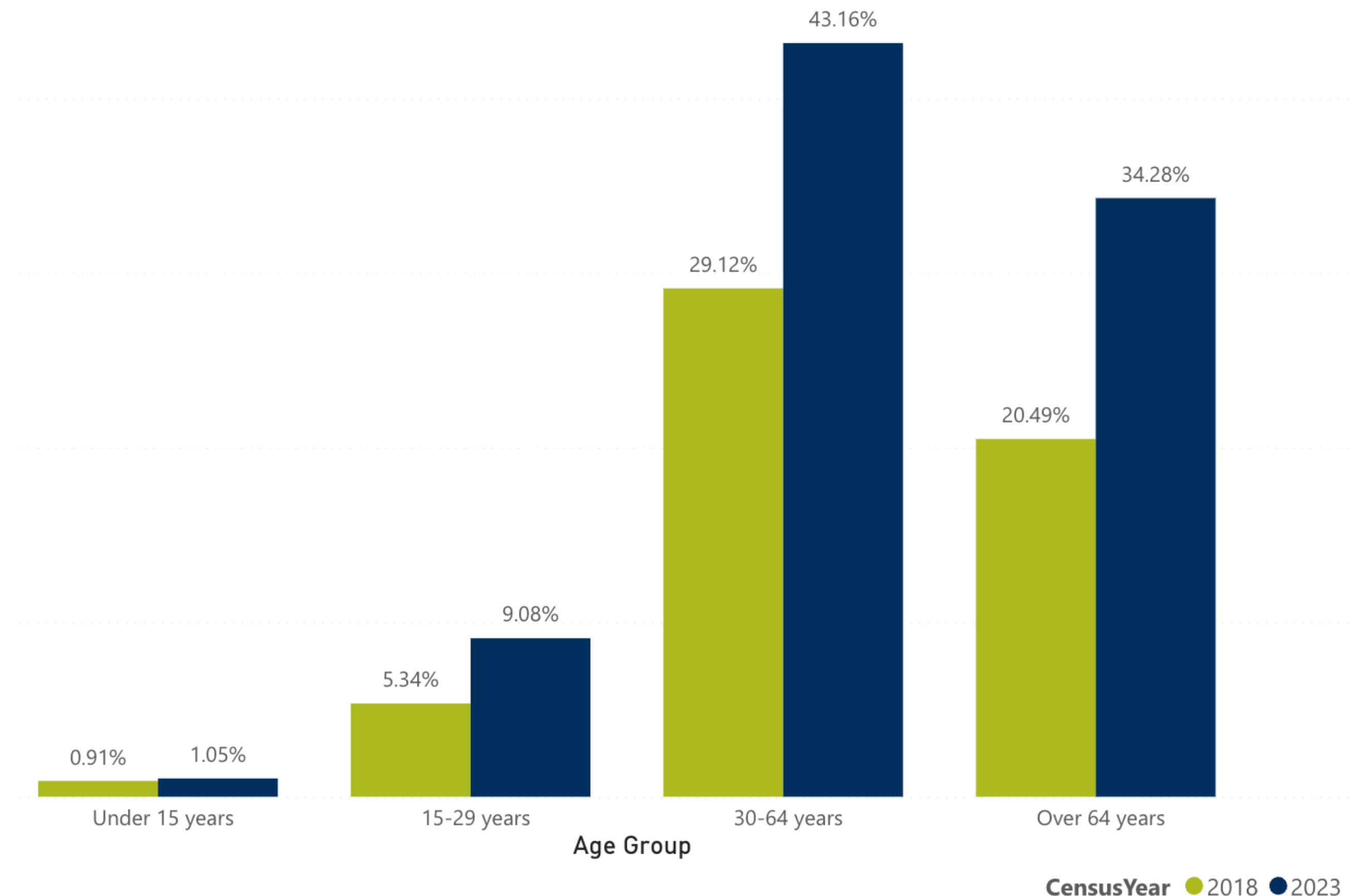
Structural shift towards studying from home


+57% Growth

Increase in Study at Home nationally

- ✓ Strongest growth among adult learners (tertiary).
- ✓ Lasting reduction in physical education trips.

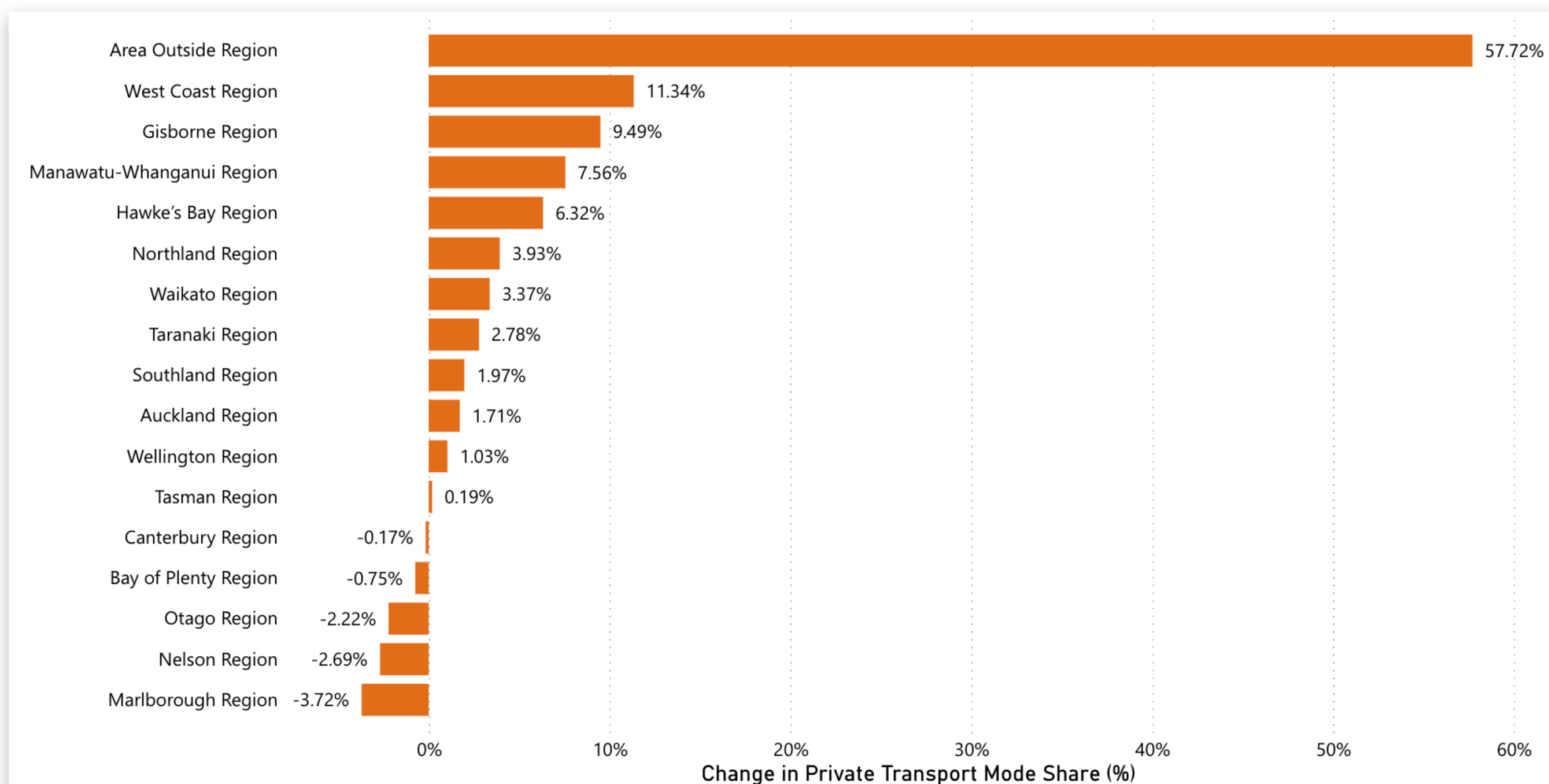
Mode Share % of Students Studying From Home (2018 vs 2023)





Private transport remains dominant

Change in Private Transport Mode Share % by Region (2018 vs 2023)



50%+ Share

Nationally, private transport is still the primary mode for education.

Youth Impact

Increased use specifically among younger students (school run).

Congestion

Continues to drive peak-hour demand around schools.

Public transport declined unevenly



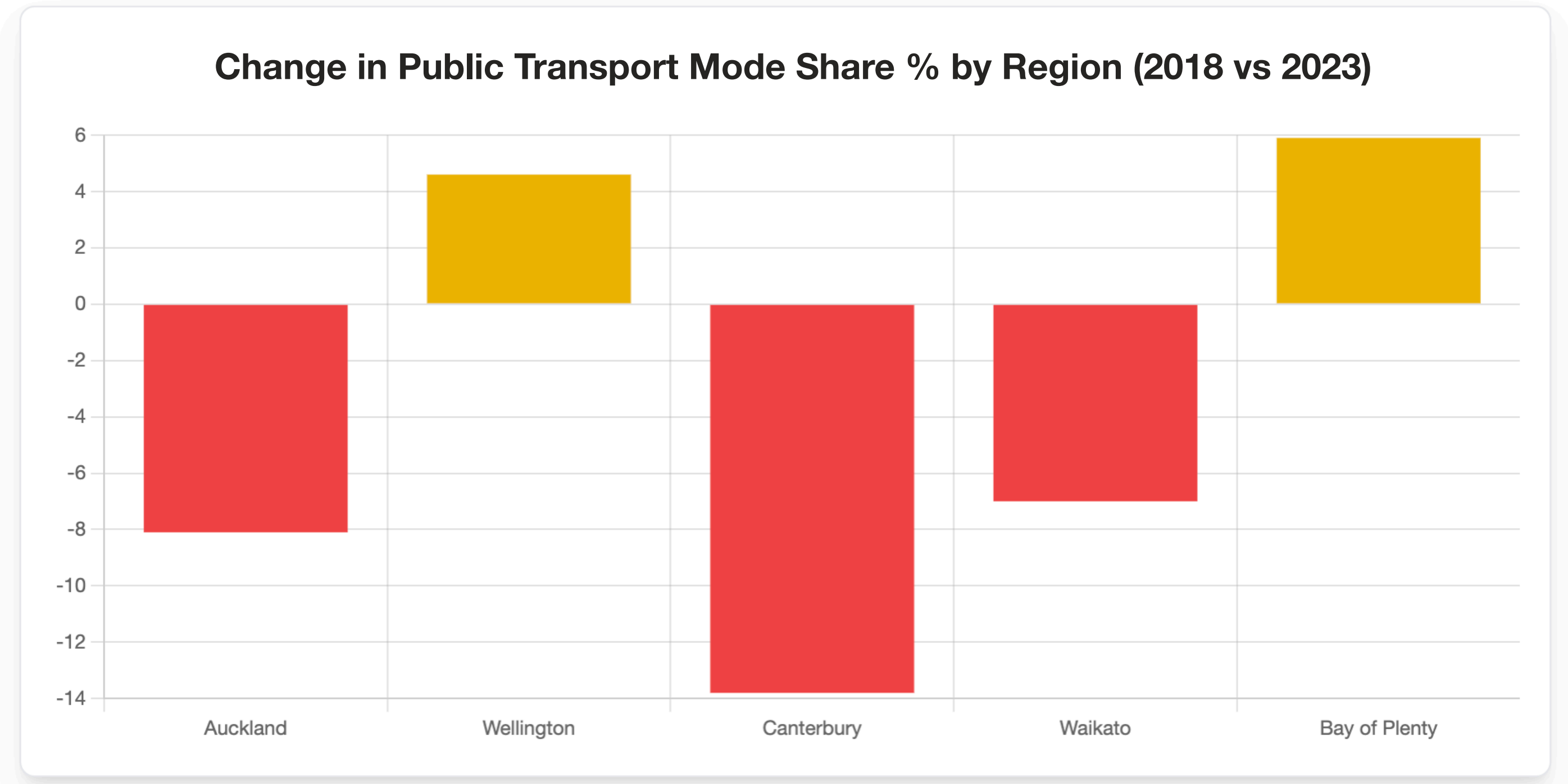
Public Transport Decline Varies by Region

Public transport use for education declined between 2018 and 2023, with variation across regions and age groups.



Stronger Impact Among Adult Students

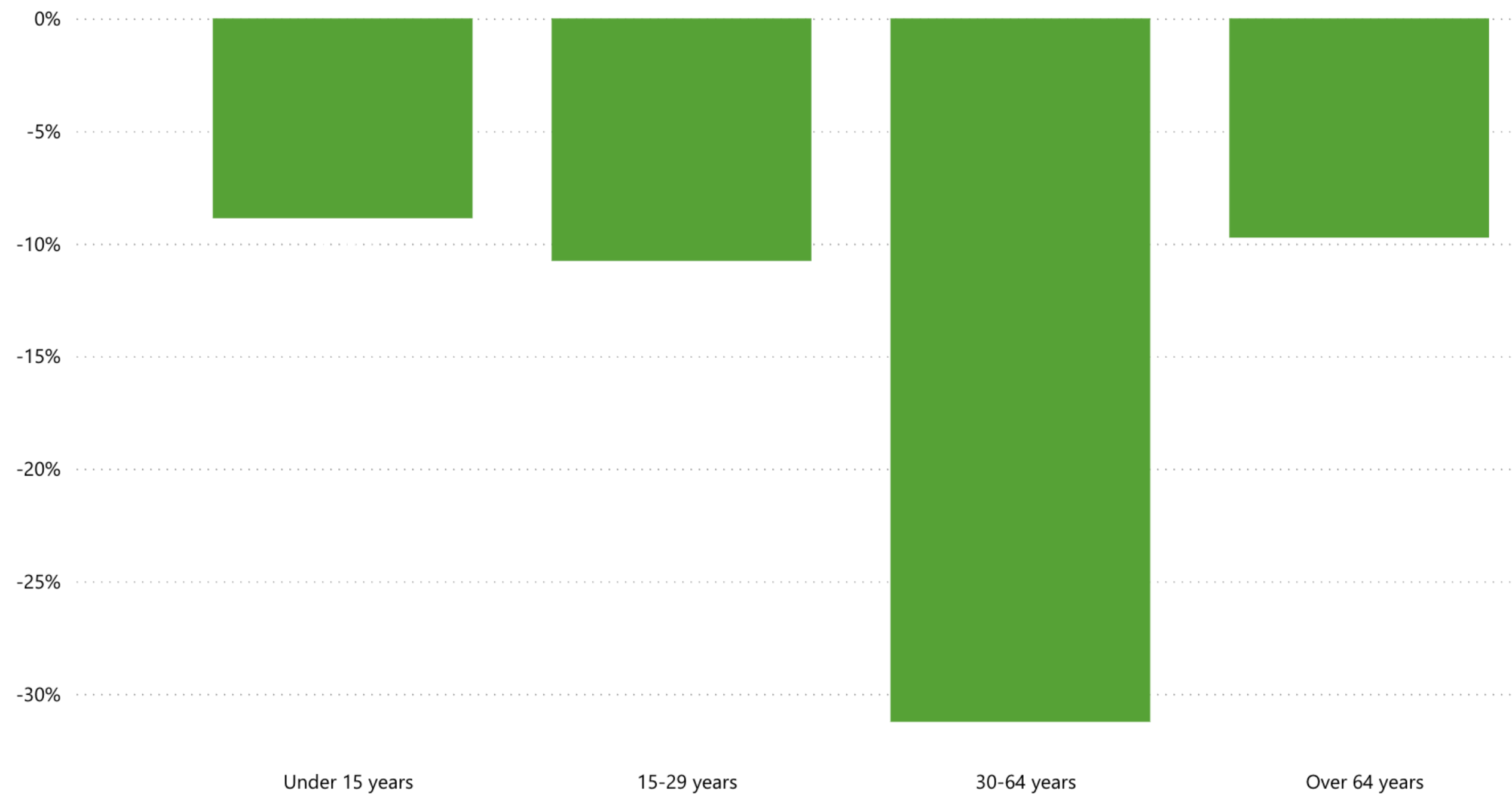
The largest reductions occurred among 30-64 year olds, likely reflecting increased remote study and less campus commuting.





Active transport declined, especially in non-urbanised regions

Change in Active Transport Mode Share % by Age Group (2018 vs 2023)



-11%

National decline since 2018.

-20%+

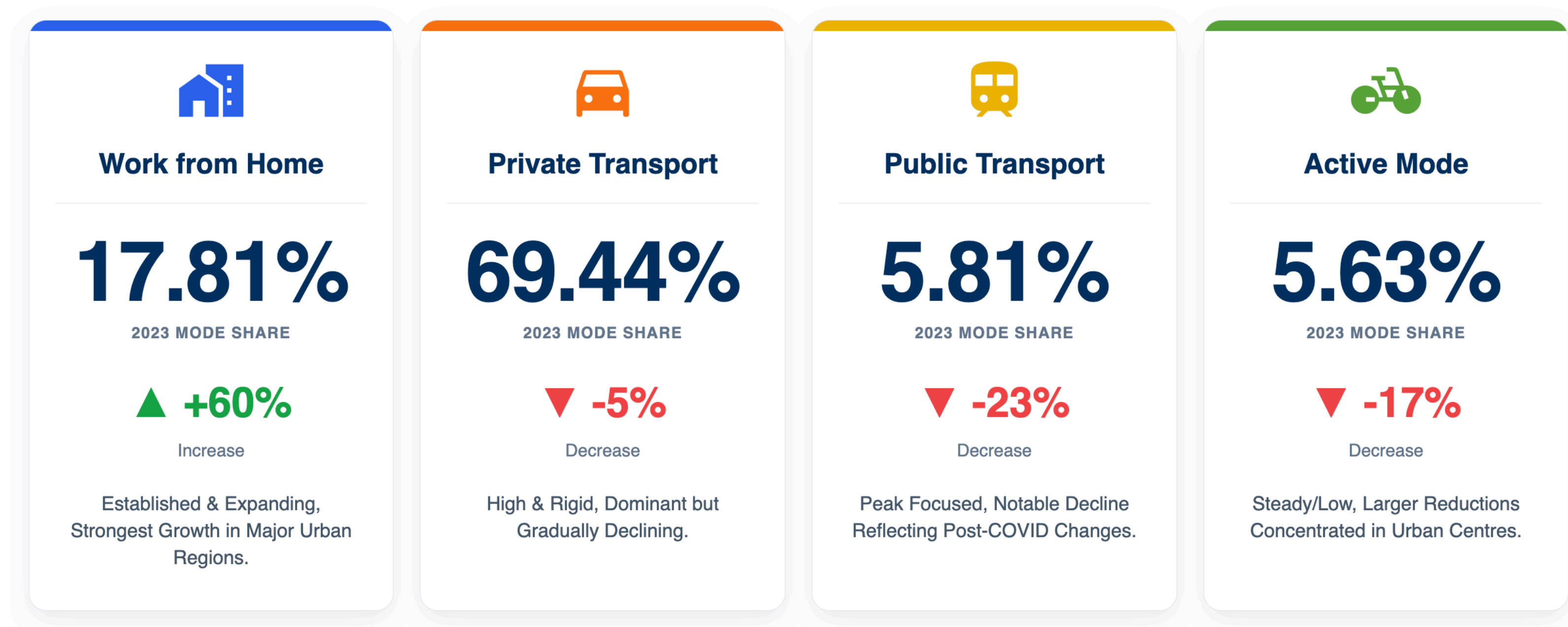
Decline in some provincial/rural regions (e.g. Gisborne, West Coast).

Congestion

Larger decline among older students/tertiary.

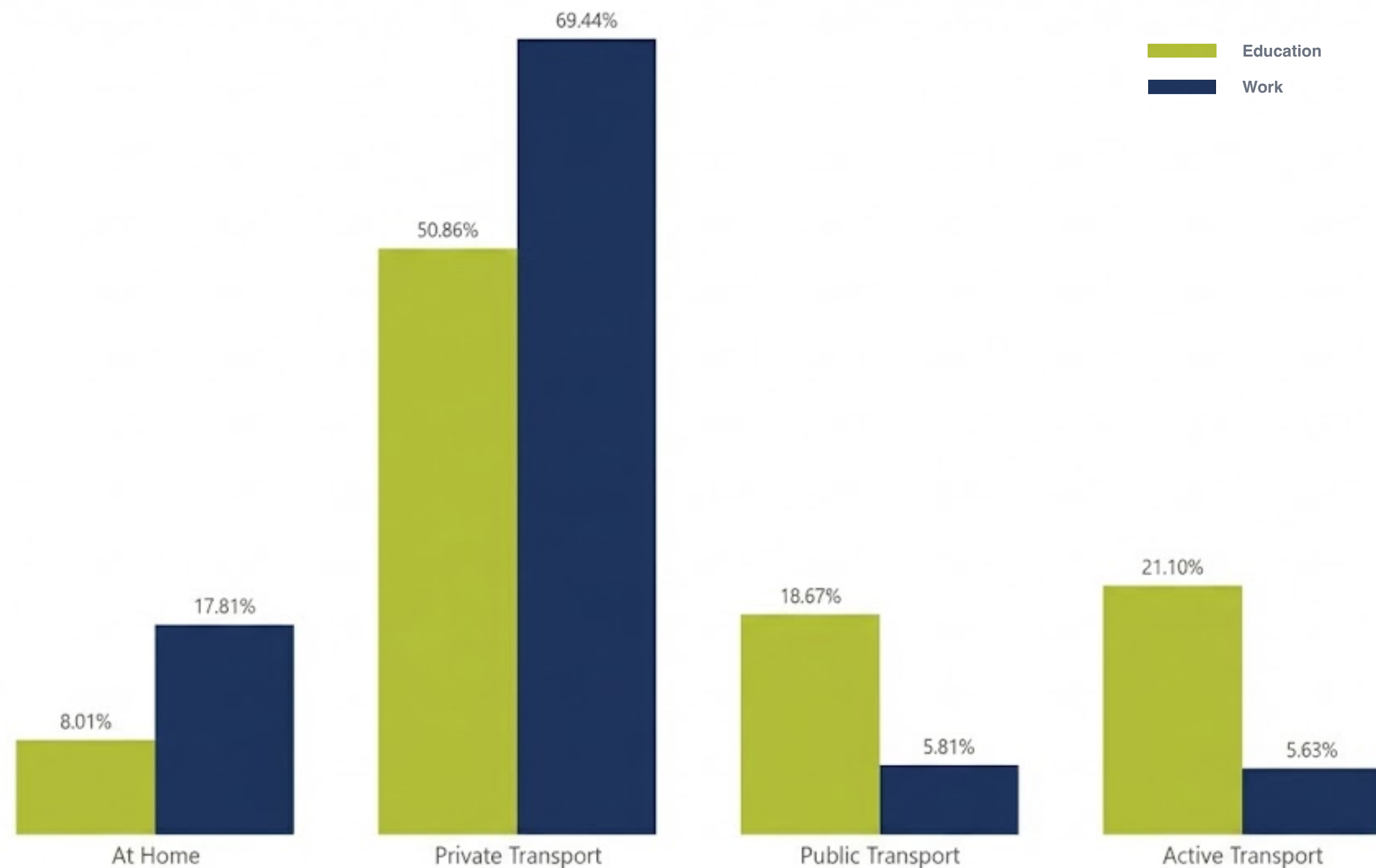
Journey to Work: A Stable but Shifting Baseline

Private transport dominates, but post-COVID shifts are visible.



Do Education and Work Journeys Behave the Same?

MODE SHARE COMPARISON (2023)



Education

Higher Active & Passenger share. More responsive to local infrastructure.

Work

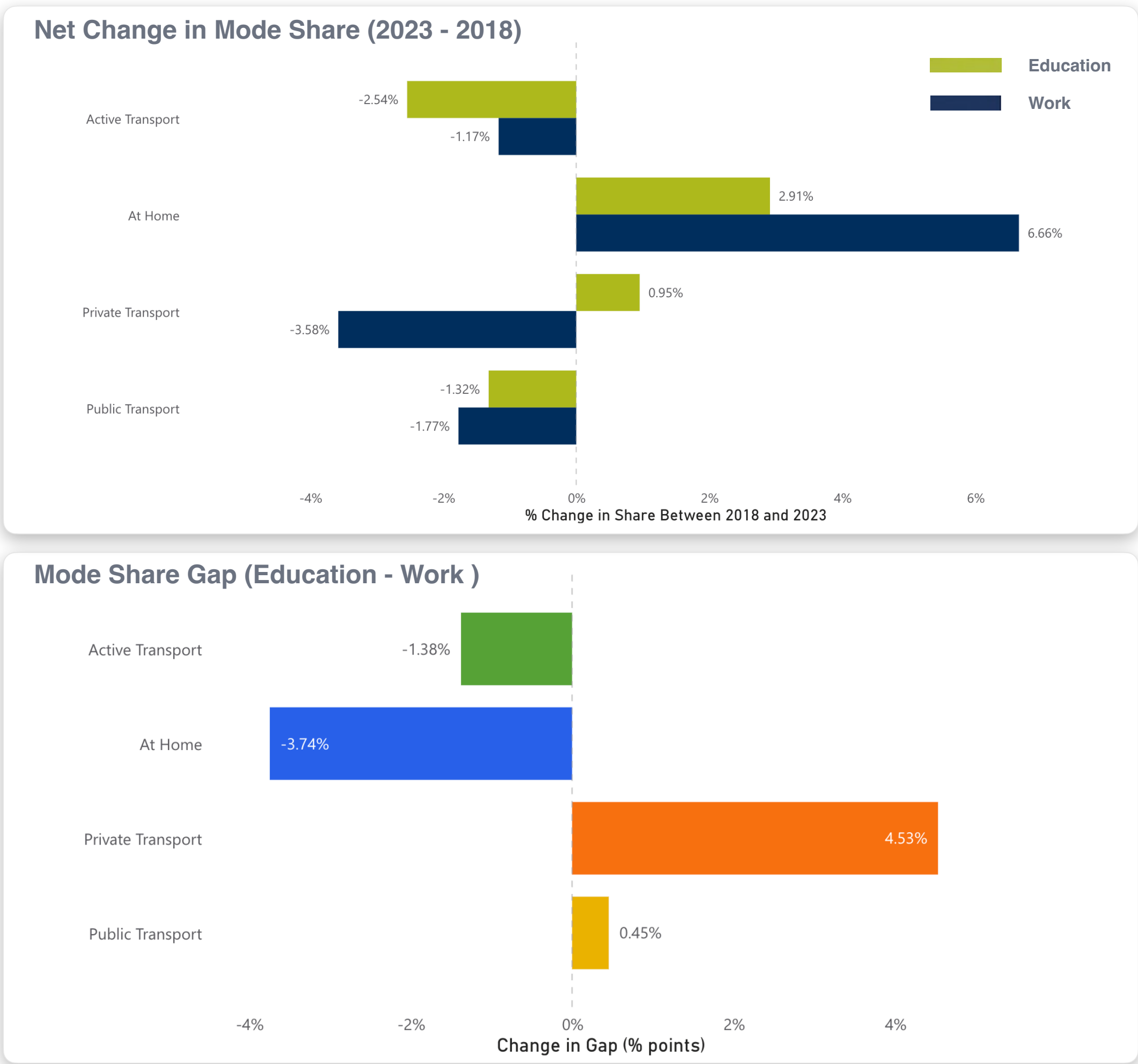
Dominated by Private Driver. Rigid habits.

Education and Work Show Distinct Behavioural Patterns

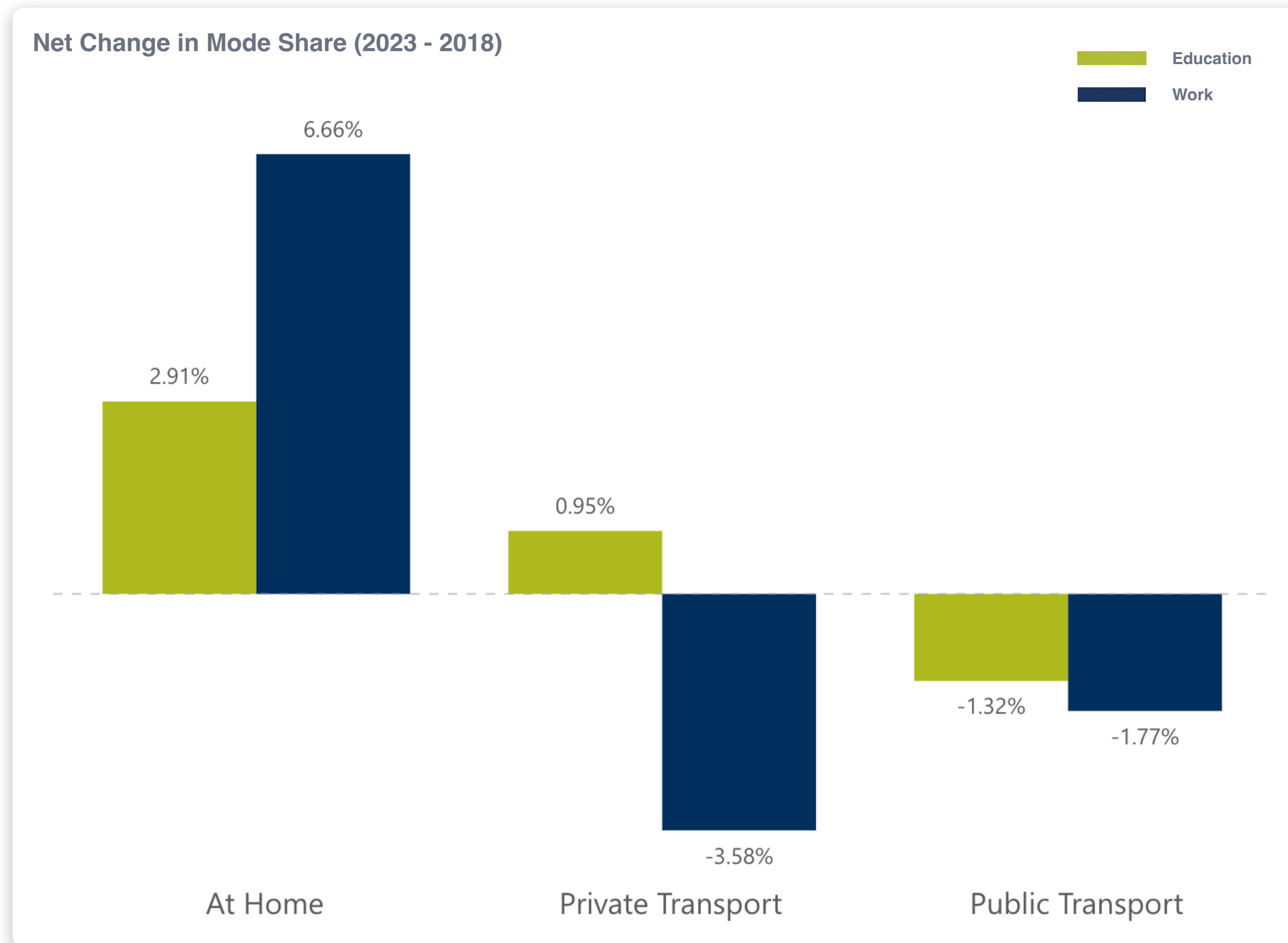
Education ≠ Work

When we directly compare mode shifts between 2018 and 2023, we see distinct behavioural divergences.

Education is more "place-bound" and resilient in Private Transport use, whereas Work shows greater elasticity.



Mode-Level Differences: Where are the gaps?



At Home: Work > Education

Remote work uptake was nearly double that of remote study. Work is more flexible; Education (especially schools) remains location-based.

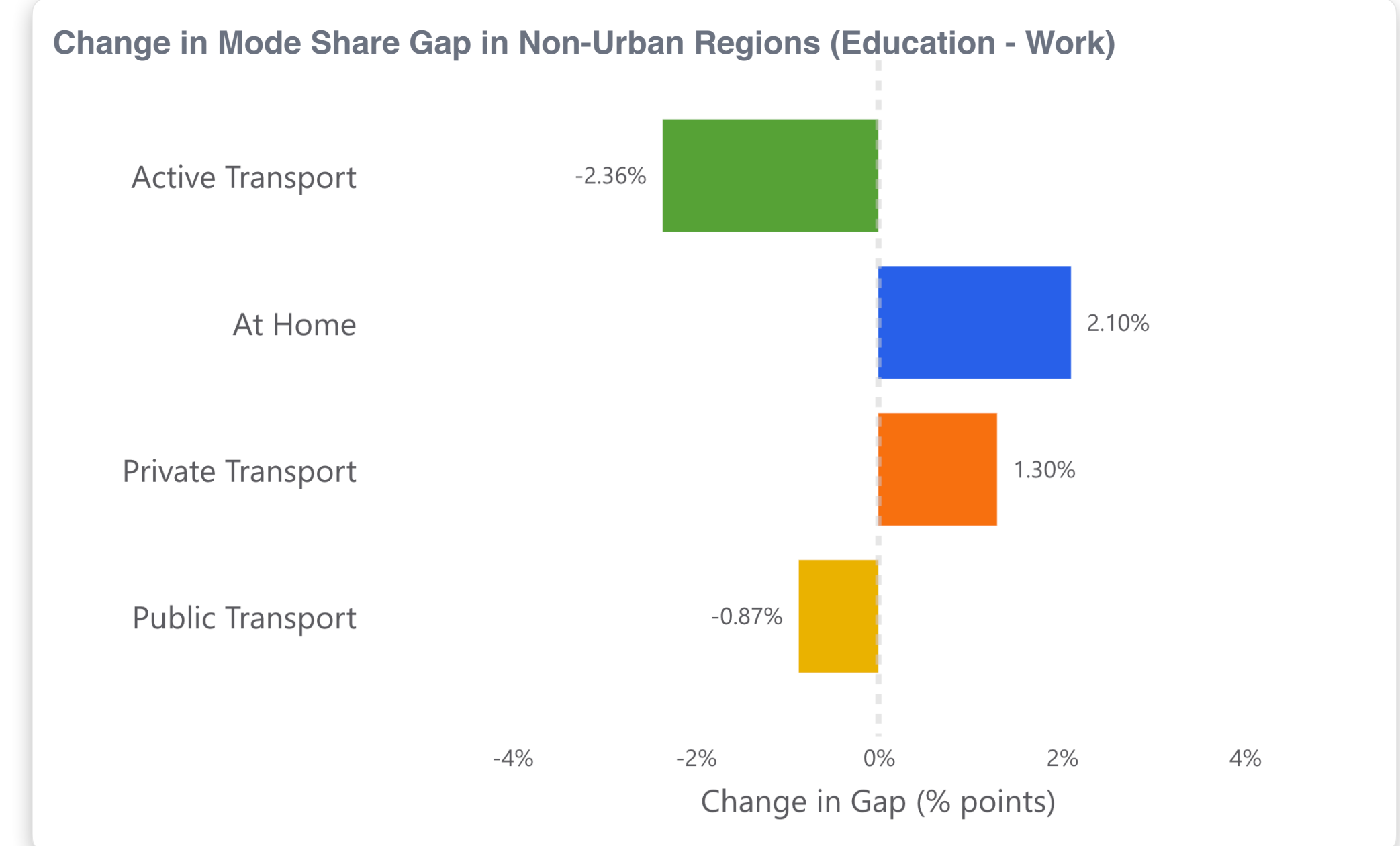
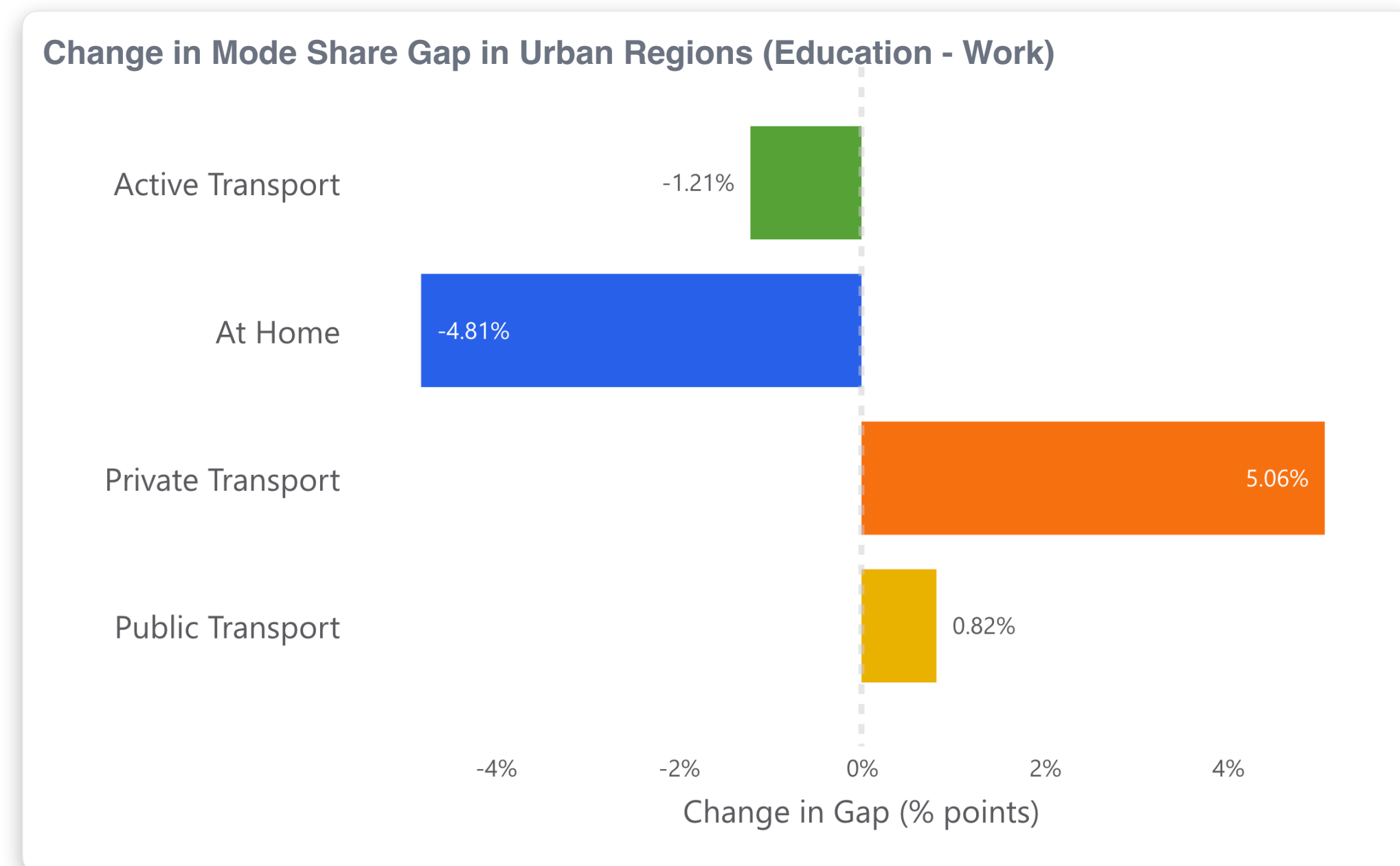
Private Transport

Education car trips actually increased in share slightly (driven by school run), while work car trips decreased.

Public Transport Divergence

Work commuting on PT dropped sharper than Education. Students remain a captive market for PT in main centres.

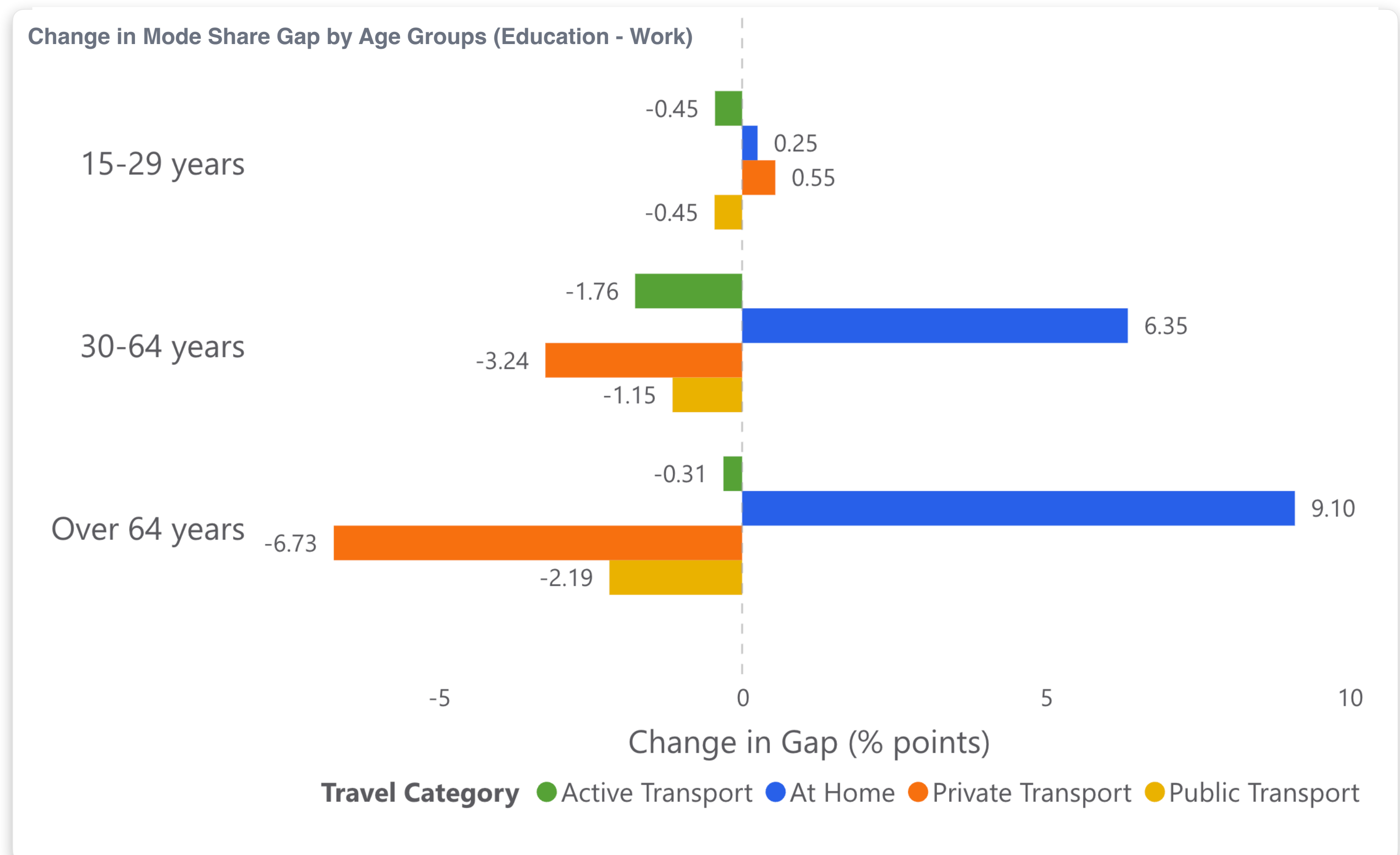
Urbanised and Non-Urbanised Regional Divergence



- ✓ At-home gap moved in opposite directions.
- ✓ Private transport divergence strongest in urban areas.
- ✓ Public and active gaps behave differently by geography.

Age is the Primary Driver

- ✓ Largest divergence observed among 30-64 year olds.
- ✓ Younger cohorts show relatively parallel shifts.
- ✓ Life stage influences remote and mode flexibility.





Power BI Demo